

Don’t trust the voice. Trust the call-back.

5 steps to stop fake bosses, fake vendors, and fake urgent requests.

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01 Set the triggers

02 Call back on a known number

03 Add a second approver

04 Give key people a safe word

05 Make pausing safe

SWIPE →

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

WHAT THE FBI REPORTED

$3.05B

lost to business email compromise in 2025, across 24,768 complaints.

FBI IC3 2025 Annual Report. Businesses reported over $30 million of it in scams involving AI.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

It won’t sound fake. That’s the point.

The FBI says AI-generated voice and video can be hard to tell from the real thing. Your team can’t rely on spotting the tell.

> Who can approve a payment at your firm today?

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

01

Set the triggers

Pick the requests that always get a check: money, bank changes, codes, passwords, and client data.

> Try this: write the list in one sentence.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

VERIFY BEFORE YOU PAY

02

Call back on a known number

Hang up. Find the number in your own records, never in the message. Call and confirm.

> Try this: keep your known numbers in one shared file.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

03

Add a second approver

Over your limit, two people sign off and write down the time of the call.

> Try this: pick the limit today, even a rough one.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

04

Give key people a safe word

Agree on it in person. Never write it in email or chat.

> The FBI suggests a safe word for families. The idea works at work too.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

VERIFY BEFORE YOU PAY

05

Make pausing safe

Tell your team: anyone can pause any request, and nobody gets in trouble for it.

> Try this: pin the message in team chat.

Source: FBI IC3, 2025 Annual Report

Your verify rule:

- [ ] Triggers listed
- [ ] Call-back on known numbers
- [ ] Second approver
- [ ] Safe word set
- [ ] Pausing is safe

FREE · CHECKLIST

Want the full Verify Before You Pay? Comment

VERIFY

on this post and I'll send it. Follow Jason Redfoot for weekly AI briefs.

Save this for your next team meeting.